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7-1 Final Project

Sprint Review & Retrospective

Throughout the experience of this class I was able to slip into the shoes of many roles; Scrum Master, Product Owner, Developer, and Tester. I was able to experience each layer of these roles and the larger part they all played when it came to working as a team. Each of these roles play an enormous part throughout the process, in drastically different ways.

A Scrum Master needs to be organized and on top of schedules, deadlines, and other members of the team. Sprint planning, Daily Scrums, backlog refinement and sprint reviews are just a few of the things, not to mention smaller and more “mundane” tasks, that fall onto the shoulders of a Scrum Master. As a Scrum Master I must develop a Sprint Plan for each sprint, ensuring everything moves in a timely and organized fashion each period. Daily Scrums are held every day at the same time to ensure the team is on top of their tasks and know where they end each day, as well as where they would like to be for the current day, and what obstacles they may have that are inhibiting them from completing their tasks and goals. I am also responsible for communication with the Product Owner to ensure development and deadlines are met with the specifications required.

As a Scum Master, I’m also responsible for backlog, sprint planning, review and retrospective. Sprint reviews and retrospectives play a huge role in the development

process where we go over what has gone well and what needs to be improved for the next sprint to ensure the product being delivered is met with the quality the Product Owner and client are seeking.

Product Owners are responsible to the client and the team. They advocate for both sides and work with both client side and team side to ensure the product being developed and delivered retains all the information, specifications and quality both sides are aiming to receive and maintain. My role as the Product Owner is not to be the Scrum Master, or a member of the development or a tester, and not the client directly, which sometimes can put me in a strange position when it comes to being a part of team discussions regarding the product. They want to ensure that the final product is what the client wants, while also trusting in the knowledge of the team and that the development team, under the eye of the Scrum Master, know what they are doing and know what takes priority. As a Product Owner it can sometimes be hard to walk the line of management and not micro-manage a team, which could lead to disruptions during development or testing, causing setbacks. In this role it's important to remember to set a priority, but to understand the team's decision on what takes priority throughout the following weeks.

Developers are the backbone and need to be able to work independently and as a unit to ensure that a usable product is delivered. Much like with Testers, and all the other roles, I found that communication played a large part of this role, as developers talk not only amongst themselves but with the Product Owner and Scrum Master as well. Agile methodology enabled us to work as a team to bring up issues and critical elements that require more work and ensure that smaller and more manageable items were met and completed, not left to the end or forgotten during development. As developers we are also

in the position to require clarification and understanding changes that may come up in the middle of development, where certain items may need to be changed, removed or touched up, and ensure that these changes don't incur a backlog of work or any disruptions to the schedule and the final deadline.

Testers rely heavily on communication and require a lot of detail from the client and make use of user stories to ensure all the requirements and expectations are met. As a Tester it was imperative for me to enable as much information as possible from various resources to ensure all aspects of the product were met at each stage of development. Below is an example email of a request for clarification.

To: Product Owner

Subject: Clarification Needed on User Stories

Good morning [PRODUCT OWNER]!

I hope this email finds you well. I am writing to you today to get some clarification of the user stories you provided our team with, so that I can best ensure that the final product's expectations are met by yourself, the team, and the users involved. I would love it if you could provide a little more information for my team so that we can implement all the necessary details and requirements to make a seamless site for the SNHU Travel Website. Any additional details and information are extremely helpful. If you have any further questions, please don't hesitate to reach out to me. Thank you and have a wonderful day!

Sydney

User stories are important because they give explicit details that the team can utilize when it comes to developing features in the final product. Both positive and negative feedback help to flag important information to either include or avoid. Included below is a test user story that included details that were helpful to the team in the development phase. Having information like this gives developers and testers understand what people are looking for when it comes to the final product.

User Story Number:	5
User Story Name:	Be able to adjust my travel settings, like favorite destinations, in my settings.
User Story Size:	Large
User Story Value Statement:	As an end user, I want to be able to set my favorite types of travel in my profile, so that I can see more options available that suit my favorite types already.
Acceptance Criteria:	• Create an option in the user profile for: • Types of preferred travel methods (cruises, train rides, plane, etc.) • Destination types (tropics, cities, popular tourist destinations, etc.) • Prior destinations & travel methods • Activities in said locales (museum, guided tours, group activities, etc.)

Thanks to the Agile approach, even the changes implemented didn't halt progress of the work. The Agile approach enabled the team to be able to pivot while not causing any disruptions or increased backlog, allowing them to make the changes requested. The Agile method allowed the team to continue to work and move forward, unlike the waterfall method where all testing would be completed at the end, which may have caused a larger backlog and a halt in progress. This could have ended up with the team

missing the deadline, but because we were implementing the Agile method, we were able to effectively pivot and continue to work through with sprints.

Communication is one of the most important and crucial skills that needs to be implemented not only by the Scrum Master and Product Owner, but the Developers and Testers as well. I believe communication across the board is key and having open dialogue with one another allows us to be able to seamlessly work through any changes, hiccups and disruptions and questions throughout the weeks. Daily Scrums were an invaluable part of each day, ensuring that each team member was aware of their current goals, what they needed to improve on, and where the overall status of the project was. Having these daily meetings was a huge help when team members expressed needing additional time, information and resources that enabled them to work at their most effective pace.

The most effective Agile tool was communication. I fully believe having open communication as well as daily meetings and ensuring a lot of face-to-face time with the entire team was what led to the ultimate success of the project's completion. While other tools were helpful along the way reflections and sprint meetings also were a large help. From these meetings and having open communication we were able to determine where we needed to pivot and adjust based on time, priorities and a team collaborative effort. Having the support of the entire team working individually and collectively gave everyone a good rapport and encouraged the team to work together on their goals.

I believe that the Scrum-Agile approach was a good approach for the SNHU Travel development project overall. There are always going to be pros and cons when it comes to a project and how it is handled throughout the development, but ultimately, I believe

there were more pros than cons. The Scrum-Agile approach enabled us to be able to pivot and adapt to changes, we had daily meetings to ensure everyone was transparent with their status. Multiple sprints allowed everyone to work in bursts, and each sprint review gave a good indication on where we needed to adapt moving into the next sprint, so each team member ensured those issues didn't become repetitive. Some of the cons that could arise could be related to work getting lost along the way, user stories not being clear or providing enough information. A back-and-forth for clarification could halt progress when it came to certain aspects of the project, which could lead to further issues and hangups down the line. Some team members, after a long day, sometimes didn't update their progress to bring to the daily meeting the following day, which slowed down the meeting time and cut into the workday, which produced side bars that needed to be discussed at later times. Overall, there are always going to be pros and cons to any project, but it is imperative at the end of the day to have open communication with one another to ensure that everyone knows exactly where they stand daily.